

MODULE

6

Animal Behaviors

*"We each survive
in our own way."*

— SARAH J. MAAS

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

What behaviors help animals survive?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1 **This Is Your Life Cycle** · Heather Lynn Miller NARRATIVE NONFICTION / FANTASY

2 **The Nose Awards** INFORMATIONAL TEXT

3 **Octopus Escapes Again!** · Laurie Ellen Angus NARRATIVE NONFICTION

4 **T.J. The Siberian Tiger Cub** · Nagda & Bickel INFORMATIONAL TEXT

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A · Vocabulary (23)	p. 2
B · Reading Comprehension (32)	p. 5
C · IB Critical Thinking (5)	p. 12
D · MAP Practice (20)	p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____



Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 6 · Animal Behaviors · Grade 3 · 23 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

hatch

An animal can **hatch** when it —

- ☐ **A.** grows a new tail.
- ☐ **B.** breaks out of its egg by itself.
- ☐ **C.** swims to the top of the water.
- ☐ **D.** goes to sleep for the winter.

Q2 L.3.6

universal

When something is **universal**, it —

- ☐ **A.** happens only once a year.
- ☐ **B.** belongs to one animal alone.
- ☐ **C.** applies to everyone.
- ☐ **D.** is very far away in space.

Q3 L.3.5 **TRAP**

span

A frog goes through stages during its life **span**. A **span** is —

- ☐ **A.** the length of time something lasts.
- ☐ **B.** a flat bridge over a river.
- ☐ **C.** the wide reach of two open wings.
- ☐ **D.** a small pan used for cooking.

Q4 L.3.6

growth

Growth happens when something —

- ☐ **A.** stays exactly the same.
- ☐ **B.** hides under the leaves.
- ☐ **C.** moves from place to place.
- ☐ **D.** gets older and/or bigger.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THIS IS YOUR LIFE CYCLE

Q5 L.3.4

larvae

Insects that have just hatched and have not yet changed to their adult form are called **larvae**. **Larvae** are —

- ☐ **A.** fully grown adult insects.
- ☐ **B.** the eggs an insect lays.
- ☐ **C.** young insects that have just hatched and have not yet become adults.
- ☐ **D.** the wings of a flying insect.

Q6 L.3.4

molt

When insects or other animals **molt**, they —

- ☐ **A.** lose their outer covering, such as skin or feathers.
- ☐ **B.** dig a deep hole in the mud.
- ☐ **C.** lay their eggs on a leaf.
- ☐ **D.** call loudly to other animals.

Q7 L.3.5

TRAP

unsuspecting

Dahlia ate an **unsuspecting** tadpole. If you are **unsuspecting**, you —

- ☐ **A.** are sure that something is wrong.
- ☐ **B.** are looking everywhere for danger.
- ☐ **C.** have done something against the rules.
- ☐ **D.** do not notice something that is happening or may happen.

Q8 L.3.4

deposited

Dahlia's mother **deposited** the eggs in the grass. If you **deposited** something in a place, you —

- ☐ **A.** took it away with you.
- ☐ **B.** left it there.
- ☐ **C.** broke it into pieces.
- ☐ **D.** ate it for a meal.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THIS IS YOUR LIFE CYCLE (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.3.5

TRAP

patch

The mother found a **patch** of swamp grass. A **patch** is —

- ☐ **A.** a small area of something, such as land or fabric.
- ☐ **B.** a piece of cloth sewn over a hole.
- ☐ **C.** a cover worn over one eye.
- ☐ **D.** a quick fix for a problem.

Q10 L.3.4

cumbersome

Dahlia crawled out of her **cumbersome** exoskeleton. Something that is **cumbersome** is —

- ☐ **A.** soft and light as a feather.
- ☐ **B.** shiny and brightly colored.
- ☐ **C.** heavy and hard to carry or wear.
- ☐ **D.** warm and comfortable to wear.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE NOSE AWARDS

Q11 L.3.4

keener

A bear's sense of smell is even **keener** than a dog's. If an animal's senses are **keener**, they are —

- ☐ **A.** weaker and harder to use.
- ☐ **B.** better, sharper, or more developed.
- ☐ **C.** located inside the mouth.
- ☐ **D.** used only at night.

Q12 L.3.4

nostrils

A hippo's **nostrils** face upward. **Nostrils** are —

- ☐ **A.** the long arms of an octopus.
- ☐ **B.** sharp teeth used for chewing.
- ☐ **C.** the soft pads on an animal's feet.
- ☐ **D.** openings in a nose that take in air for breathing or smelling.

Q13 L.3.5 **TRAP**

trumpet

An elephant can **trumpet** with its trunk. To **trumpet** is to —

- ☐ **A.** loudly call out or make a sound.
- ☐ **B.** play a brass musical instrument.
- ☐ **C.** spray water over its back.
- ☐ **D.** pick up a small coin from the ground.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · OCTOPUS ESCAPES AGAIN!

Q14 L.3.4

flexible

An octopus has no bones, which makes it very **flexible**. If something is **flexible**, it —

- ☐ **A.** is hard as a rock.
- ☐ **B.** can only move in a straight line.
- ☐ **C.** can bend or change shape without breaking.
- ☐ **D.** floats on top of the water.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · OCTOPUS ESCAPES AGAIN! (CONTINUED)

Q15 L.3.4

siphon

An octopus blasts water out through its **siphon**. A **siphon** is —

- ☐ **A.** a hard outer shell.
- ☐ **B.** a tube or hose used to pull liquid in or out.
- ☐ **C.** a cloud of dark ink.
- ☐ **D.** a kind of underwater plant.

Q16 L.3.4

lurking

A predator was **lurking** near the reef. If an animal is **lurking**, it is —

- ☐ **A.** swimming away as fast as it can.
- ☐ **B.** sleeping in its den.
- ☐ **C.** calling out to other animals.
- ☐ **D.** hiding while it waits to catch another creature.

Q17 L.3.4

invisible

The octopus uses camouflage to become almost **invisible**. If something is **invisible**, it —

- ☐ **A.** cannot be seen.
- ☐ **B.** is bright and easy to spot.
- ☐ **C.** makes a very loud noise.
- ☐ **D.** is too heavy to lift.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · T.J. THE SIBERIAN TIGER CUB

Q18 L.3.4

nuzzled

Buhkra **nuzzled** her new cub. If one animal **nuzzled** another, it —

- ☐ **A.** chased it across the den.
- ☐ **B.** growled at it angrily.
- ☐ **C.** gently touched it with its nose and mouth.
- ☐ **D.** carried it up a tall tree.

Q19 L.3.5 TRAP

bared

When T.J. was scared, he **bared** his teeth. If an animal **bared** its teeth, it —

- ☐ **A.** lost them one by one.
- ☐ **B.** showed them to others.
- ☐ **C.** brushed them clean.
- ☐ **D.** hid them behind its lips.

Q20 L.3.4

assistant

Cindy was a veterinary **assistant**. An **assistant** is —

- ☐ **A.** a doctor who owns the whole hospital.
- ☐ **B.** an animal that lives at the zoo.
- ☐ **C.** a visitor who watches the tigers.
- ☐ **D.** someone who helps another person do his or her work.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · T.J. THE SIBERIAN TIGER CUB (CONTINUED)

Q21 L.3.4

refused

At first, T.J. **refused** the meat in his bowl. If you **refused** something, you —

- ☐ **A.** did not take it.
- ☐ **B.** ate all of it quickly.
- ☐ **C.** shared it with a friend.
- ☐ **D.** saved it for later.

Q22 L.3.4

nursery

T.J. rolled around in the **nursery**. A **nursery** is —

- ☐ **A.** a cage made of strong metal bars.
- ☐ **B.** a tall mountain in the wild.
- ☐ **C.** a place where babies or young children are cared for.
- ☐ **D.** a bowl used to hold an animal's food.

Q23 L.3.4

pounce

T.J. learned to **pounce** while playing. If you **pounce**, you —

- ☐ **A.** walk away slowly and quietly.
- ☐ **B.** jump on something suddenly and hold on to it.
- ☐ **C.** roll over onto your back.
- ☐ **D.** curl up to take a nap.



Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 6 · Animal Behaviors · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.3.1 · RI.3.2 · RI.3.3 · RI.3.5 · RI.3.6 · RI.3.8

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · This Is Your Life Cycle

NARRATIVE NONFICTION / FANTASY · HEATHER LYNN MILLER / MICHAEL CHESWORTH · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.3.2

What is this selection mostly about?

- ☐ A. How to build a real television studio.
- ☐ B. The stages of a dragonfly's life, told as a TV game show.
- ☐ C. Why beetles make the best show hosts.
- ☐ D. The best way to catch a tadpole.

Q2 RI.3.3

In what order does a dragonfly go through its life cycle?

- ☐ A. Adult, then nymph, then egg.
- ☐ B. Nymph, then egg, then adult.
- ☐ C. Egg, then nymph, then fast-flying adult.
- ☐ D. Egg, then adult, then nymph.

Q3 RI.3.3

How does Dahlia survive the dangerous nymph stage?

- ☐ A. She flies away from the swamp.
- ☐ B. She grows a hard outer shell.
- ☐ C. She asks Bob Beetle to protect her.
- ☐ D. She hides under rotting leaves, logs, and swamp grasses.

Q4 RI.3.3

Why is the nymph stage described as a time when Dahlia is both predator and prey?

- ☐ A. She eats smaller animals like tadpoles, but bigger animals try to eat her.
- ☐ B. She is too young to eat anything at all.
- ☐ C. She only eats plants in the swamp.
- ☐ D. She lives alone and never meets another animal.

Q5 RI.3.3

What does Dahlia's water jet help her do as a nymph?

- ☐ A. Breathe air on land.
- ☐ B. Shoot through the water like a torpedo so no one can catch her.
- ☐ C. Build a nest out of grass.
- ☐ D. Stick to the bottom of the pond.

Q6 RI.3.3

What happens to Dahlia after she molts and rests in the sun?

- ☐ A. She turns back into an egg.
- ☐ B. She loses her ability to fly.
- ☐ C. She becomes a fast-flying adult that can hover, dart, and flip.
- ☐ D. She returns to live underwater forever.

Q7 RI.3.6

The author uses a make-believe game show with talking insects to tell true facts. Why does the author tell the information this way?

- ☐ A. To make learning real facts about a dragonfly's life fun and entertaining.
- ☐ B. To prove that insects can really host TV shows.
- ☐ C. To explain how cameras work in a swamp.
- ☐ D. To teach readers how to play a game show.

Q8 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "This Is Your Life Cycle"?

- ☐ A. Dragonflies are the fastest insects on Earth and can fly in several directions.
- ☐ B. A funny insect game show is the best way to meet a mystery guest.
- ☐ C. A mother dragonfly lays over 800 eggs in the blades of swamp grass.
- ☐ D. At each stage of its life cycle, a dragonfly's behaviors help it grow and survive.

Selection 2 · The Nose Awards

INFORMATIONAL TEXT (MAGAZINE ARTICLE) · ILLUS. MANU CALLEJÓN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.3.2

What is the article "The Nose Awards" mostly about?

- ☐ **A.** How to take care of a pet elephant.
- ☐ **B.** Animals with amazing noses and the special ways they use them.
- ☐ **C.** Why people have the best noses of all.
- ☐ **D.** How to win a real award show.

Q10 RI.3.5

The article uses headings like "Best Smeller" and "Most Talented." How do these headings help the reader?

- ☐ **A.** They tell the reader the price of the magazine.
- ☐ **B.** They list the names of the photographers.
- ☐ **C.** They tell what each part, or award, is about before you read it.
- ☐ **D.** They show how long the article will be.

Q11 RI.3.1

According to the article, why is a bear's sense of smell so useful?

- ☐ **A.** Bears have poor eyesight but can smell food from miles away, even buried or in a can.
- ☐ **B.** Bears use their noses to see in the dark.
- ☐ **C.** Bears smell only with their tongues.
- ☐ **D.** Bears cannot smell anything at all.

Q12 RI.3.3

How does a snake smell its food if it does not use its nostrils to smell?

- ☐ **A.** It uses its keen eyesight instead.
- ☐ **B.** It listens for its food with sharp ears.
- ☐ **C.** It flicks its tongue to catch scent particles and carries them to smell detectors in its mouth.
- ☐ **D.** It digs underground to find food by touch.

Q13 RI.3.3

How does a star-nosed mole use the "fingers" on its nose?

- ☐ **A.** To swim quickly through water.
- ☐ **B.** To call loudly to other moles.
- ☐ **C.** To climb up the sides of trees.
- ☐ **D.** To feel for worms and bugs to eat as it tunnels underground.

Q14 RI.3.8

The author writes that a hippo can breathe while almost underwater. Which detail BEST supports this idea?

- ☐ A. The hippo's nostrils face upward and stick out of the water like a snorkel.
- ☐ B. The hippo spends the hot day staying cool.
- ☐ C. The hippo has a very large mouth.
- ☐ D. The hippo is a big, heavy animal.

Q15 RI.3.6

Why does the author call the nose award the "Elly"?

- ☐ A. It is named after a famous scientist.
- ☐ B. It is short for elephant, the animal the article opens with.
- ☐ C. It is the sound an elephant makes.
- ☐ D. It is the name of the magazine.

Q16 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "The Nose Awards"?

- ☐ A. The elephant is the only animal whose nose is useful for more than breathing.
- ☐ B. An animal's nose is used only for breathing and never for anything else.
- ☐ C. The star-nosed mole has the strangest nose of any animal in the article.
- ☐ D. Many animals have special noses that help them smell, eat, breathe, and survive.

Selection 3 · Octopus Escapes Again!

NARRATIVE NONFICTION · LAURIE ELLEN ANGUS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.3.3

What is Octopus trying to do throughout the story?

- ☐ A. Find a new den to live in.
- ☐ B. Hunt for food while escaping animals that want to eat her.
- ☐ C. Teach other octopuses how to swim.
- ☐ D. Race a sea turtle to the surface.

Q18 RI.3.3

How does being flexible help Octopus escape the sea turtle?

- ☐ A. She grows a hard shell of her own.
- ☐ B. She swims faster than the turtle can.
- ☐ C. Because she has no bones, she squeezes her soft body into an empty shell.
- ☐ D. She scares the turtle away with a loud sound.

Q19 RI.3.3

How does the cloud of ink help Octopus get away from the eel?

- ☐ A. The ink makes the eel sleepy.
- ☐ B. The ink confuses the attacker and hides Octopus so she can escape.
- ☐ C. The ink tastes bad to the eel.
- ☐ D. The ink turns the water warm.

Q20 RI.3.3

How does Octopus make her fast "BLAST OFF" escape?

- ☐ A. She sucks in water and blasts it out through her siphon to shoot away.
- ☐ B. She flaps her arms like wings.
- ☐ C. She rides on the back of a shark.
- ☐ D. She pushes off the ocean floor with her beak.

Q21 RI.3.5

The selection uses a larger dark font for the story and a smaller blue font for facts. What do the blue-font parts give the reader?

- ☐ A. The names of the people who drew the pictures.
- ☐ B. A list of questions to answer.
- ☐ C. True facts and information about real octopuses.
- ☐ D. The ending of the story.

Q22 RI.3.1

According to the facts in the selection, why is an octopus's body well suited to ocean life?

- ☐ A. It has a thick coat of fur to stay warm.
- ☐ B. It has strong bones for fighting.
- ☐ C. It has gills like a dragonfly nymph.
- ☐ D. It has eight flexible arms and no bones, so it can squeeze into small spaces.

Q23 RI.3.8

The author shows that an octopus has many ways to escape danger. Which detail BEST supports this idea?

- ☐ A. Octopus squeezes into a shell, sprays ink, blasts off with her siphon, and uses camouflage.
- ☐ B. Octopus is about two feet long and weighs 6 to 22 pounds.
- ☐ C. There are about 300 species of octopuses.
- ☐ D. Octopuses usually hunt for food at night.

Q24 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "Octopus Escapes Again!"?

- ☐ **A.** A Giant Pacific Octopus can grow almost as long as a school bus.
- ☐ **B.** Sea turtles, eels, and sharks are the main animals that hunt octopuses.
- ☐ **C.** Octopuses like to live alone in a den made of rocks or empty shells.
- ☐ **D.** An octopus uses many behaviors and adaptations to find food and escape predators.

Selection 4 · T.J. The Siberian Tiger Cub

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · NAGDA & BICKEL / HEATHER GATLEY · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RI.3.2

What is "T.J. The Siberian Tiger Cub" mostly about?

- ☐ **A.** How to build a tiger exhibit at a zoo.
- ☐ **B.** A true story of how zoo workers helped an orphaned tiger cub survive and grow.
- ☐ **C.** Why tigers make good pets.
- ☐ **D.** A made-up tale about a talking tiger.

Q26 RI.3.3

Why did the zoo staff have to raise T.J. themselves?

- ☐ **A.** His mother did not want him.
- ☐ **B.** His father carried him away.
- ☐ **C.** His mother, Buhkra, died from cancer when he was very young.
- ☐ **D.** He was moved to another zoo at birth.

Q27 RI.3.3

What problem did the staff face after T.J. came to the animal hospital?

- ☐ **A.** He refused to eat, so he was not gaining the weight he needed.
- ☐ **B.** He ate far too much food.
- ☐ **C.** He grew bigger than his father right away.
- ☐ **D.** He kept running out of his cage.

Q28 RI.3.3

How did playing hide-and-seek and pouncing help T.J.?

- ☐ **A.** It helped him learn to swim.
- ☐ **B.** It taught him to open doors.
- ☐ **C.** It was how tiger mothers teach cubs to hunt, so it helped him learn to survive.
- ☐ **D.** It made him afraid of people.

Q29 RI.3.8

The author shows that T.J. finally began to thrive. Which detail BEST supports this idea?

- ☐ A. He curled up in a corner and would not move.
- ☐ B. By fourteen weeks old he weighed nineteen pounds and was gaining weight at a steady rate.
- ☐ C. He spat the strained meat out.
- ☐ D. He lost one pound during his first days at the hospital.

Q30 RI.3.3

What happened to T.J. by the time he was four years old at ZooMontana?

- ☐ A. He had stopped eating again.
- ☐ B. He no longer remembered Cindy.
- ☐ C. He was smaller than when he was a cub.
- ☐ D. He weighed about 500 pounds and had grown bigger than his father.

Q31 RI.3.5

The author tells T.J.'s story from his birth all the way to age four, in the order things happened. What text structure is this?

- ☐ A. Chronological order, telling events from beginning to end.
- ☐ B. A list of steps for a science experiment.
- ☐ C. A question-and-answer format.
- ☐ D. A made-up fantasy story.

Q32 RI.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "T.J. The Siberian Tiger Cub"?

- ☐ A. A full-grown male tiger can weigh more than 500 pounds, like T.J. did.
- ☐ B. Cindy and the other zoo workers cared for many animals at the Denver Zoo.
- ☐ C. A bar graph and a line graph can be used to compare a cub's weight.
- ☐ D. With people's care and his own behaviors, an orphaned tiger cub learned to eat, play, and survive.



Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 6 · Animal Behaviors · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about what behaviors help animals survive. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change DOK 3

In "**This Is Your Life Cycle**," Dahlia the dragonfly changes through three stages. Show **THREE** stages of her life, then explain how the changes help her survive.

A DRAGONFLY’S LIFE CYCLE · EGG TO ADULT

STAGE 1 · EGG

STAGE 2 · NYMPH

STAGE 3 · ADULT

How does each change (hatching, hiding and molting, flying) help Dahlia survive? Explain.

Q2

Function

DOK 3

In "**The Nose Awards**," different animals use their noses in different ways. Show **THREE** animals and explain what each animal's nose does to help it survive.

HOW EACH NOSE FUNCTIONS · THE NOSE AWARDS

Noses That Help Animals Survive

ELEPHANT — WHAT CAN ITS TRUNK DO?

BEAR (OR DOG) — HOW DOES ITS KEEN SMELL
HELP?

SNAKE — HOW DOES IT SMELL ITS FOOD?

STAR-NOSED MOLE OR HIPPO — WHAT DOES
ITS NOSE DO?

Why is having a special nose an adaptation that helps an animal survive? Explain.

In "**Octopus Escapes Again!**," Octopus escapes one predator after another. Trace **THREE** escapes and name the adaptation she uses each time.

THREE ESCAPES · OCTOPUS ADAPTATIONS

ESCAPE 1 · THE SHELL

*how does Octopus get away
from the sea turtle?*

ESCAPE 2 · THE INK

*how does Octopus get away
from the eel?*

ESCAPE 3 · THE SIPHON

*how does Octopus make a fast
getaway?*

In your own words, how do an octopus's adaptations help it survive as both hunter and prey?

Two selections show very different animals surviving. Compare HOW the dragonfly in **This Is Your Life Cycle** and the tiger cub in **T.J. The Siberian Tiger Cub** survive and grow.

TWO ANIMALS · TWO WAYS TO SURVIVE AND GROW

DAHLIA · A DRAGONFLY

T.J. · A TIGER CUB

What does each animal show about how behaviors help an animal survive? (Hint: changing on its own / getting help from others.)

Essential Question: What behaviors help animals survive? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

What behavior or adaptation helps this animal survive (hiding, escaping, using a special body part, getting help)?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

What behavior or adaptation helps this animal survive (hiding, escaping, using a special body part, getting help)?

MY BIG IDEA



Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 6 · Animal Behaviors · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____

DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Camel's Hump

Camels live in the desert, where it is very hot and dry. Days can pass with no rain and no water to drink. The camel has special ways to survive. Many people think a camel stores water in its hump. That is not true. The hump is full of fat, not water. When food is hard to find, the camel's body uses the fat in the hump for energy. A camel can also drink a huge amount of water at one time. After a long, dry trip, a thirsty camel can gulp down many gallons in just a few minutes. Camels have other helpful body parts, too. They have long eyelashes that keep blowing sand out of their eyes. They can also shut their nostrils to block the sand. Wide, flat feet keep the camel from sinking into the soft sand. All of these parts help the camel live where few other animals can.

163 WORDS · LEXILE 410–460L · RIT 195–201

Q1

RIT 195

Lexile 410L

Key Detail

What is inside a camel's hump?

- ☐ **A.** Fat.
- ☐ **B.** Water.
- ☐ **C.** Sand.
- ☐ **D.** Air.

Q2

RIT 197

Lexile 420L

Key Detail

What do a camel's long eyelashes do?

- ☐ **A.** They keep the camel warm at night.
- ☐ **B.** They keep blowing sand out of the camel's eyes.
- ☐ **C.** They help the camel run faster.
- ☐ **D.** They help the camel find water.

Q3

RIT 199

Lexile 440L

Cause & Effect

What does a camel's body do when food is hard to find?

- ☐ **A.** It drinks water from the hump.
- ☐ **B.** It grows a second hump.
- ☐ **C.** It uses the fat in the hump for energy.
- ☐ **D.** It stops moving completely.

Q4 RIT 200 Lexile 450L Vocabulary

In the passage, when a thirsty camel can **gulp** down water, it —

- ☐ A. spits the water back out.
- ☐ B. takes one tiny sip.
- ☐ C. pours the water on its back.
- ☐ D. swallows a large amount quickly.

Q5 RIT 201 Lexile 460L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Camel's Hump"?

- ☐ A. A camel has many special body parts that help it survive in the desert.
- ☐ B. The most important fact about a camel is that its hump is full of fat.
- ☐ C. The desert is a hard place to live because days can pass with no rain.
- ☐ D. A camel survives mainly because it can drink many gallons of water at once.

Passage 2 · How Bees Talk

Honeybees live together in large groups called colonies. To survive, the whole colony must find flowers full of sweet nectar. But how does one bee tell the others where the food is? Bees cannot speak with words, so they "talk" by dancing. When a bee finds a good patch of flowers, it flies back to the hive and does a special dance called the waggle dance. The bee runs in a straight line while shaking, or wagging, its body. Then it circles back and dances again. The direction of the straight run tells the other bees which way to fly. The length of the waggle tells them how far away the flowers are. A short waggle means the food is close. A long waggle means the food is far. The other bees watch closely and feel the movements. Then they fly off to find the same flowers. By dancing, one bee helps the whole colony find food and survive.

162 WORDS · LEXILE 470–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 Lexile 470L Key Detail

How does a bee tell the others where food is?

- ☐ A. By buzzing very loudly.
- ☐ B. By doing a special dance.
- ☐ C. By leaving a trail of nectar.
- ☐ D. By drawing a map.

Q7 RIT 204 Lexile 490L Key Detail

What does the length of the waggle tell the other bees?

- ☐ A. What color the flowers are.
- ☐ B. How many bees should go.
- ☐ C. What time of day it is.
- ☐ D. How far away the flowers are.

Q8 RIT 205 Lexile 500L Cause & Effect

What happens after the other bees watch the dance?

- ☐ A. They start dancing for fun.
- ☐ B. They go to sleep in the hive.
- ☐ C. They build a new hive.
- ☐ D. They fly off to find the same flowers.

Q9 RIT 206 Lexile 510L Inference

The passage says bees "talk" by dancing. The quotation marks around **talk** show that bees —

- ☐ A. use real words like people do.
- ☐ B. share information in a way that is not really speaking.
- ☐ C. sing songs to each other.
- ☐ D. cannot share information at all.

Q10 RIT 207 Lexile 530L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "How Bees Talk"?

- ☐ A. Bees like to dance for fun whenever they fly back to the hive.
- ☐ B. The most important idea is that flowers are full of sweet nectar to eat.
- ☐ C. By dancing, a bee helps the whole colony find food and survive.
- ☐ D. Honeybees live together in large groups that are called colonies.

Passage 3 · The Arctic Fox

The Arctic fox lives in one of the coldest places on Earth. To survive the freezing winter, this small animal has some clever tricks. Its most amazing trick is changing color. In winter, the fox grows a thick coat of white fur. The white fur keeps the fox warm and also hides it against the snow. Hidden this way, the fox can sneak up on prey, and larger animals cannot easily spot the fox. When summer comes and the snow melts, the white fur falls out. A new coat of brown or gray fur grows in. Now the fox blends in with the rocks and dirt instead of the snow. The Arctic fox has a round body, short legs, and small ears. These keep its body heat from escaping into the cold air. It also wraps its long, bushy tail around its body like a warm blanket when it sleeps. Thanks to these adaptations, the Arctic fox can live where winters are long and harsh.

169 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 Lexile 540L Key Detail

What color is the Arctic fox's fur in winter?

- ☐ A. Brown.
- ☐ B. Gray.
- ☐ C. White.
- ☐ D. Black.

Q12 RIT 209 Lexile 560L Cause & Effect

Why does the white winter fur help the fox hunt?

- ☐ A. It hides the fox against the snow so it can sneak up on prey.
- ☐ B. It makes the fox run faster.
- ☐ C. It helps the fox swim in cold water.
- ☐ D. It lets the fox climb tall trees.

Q13 RIT 210 Lexile 570L Key Detail

What happens to the fox's white fur when summer comes?

- ☐ A. It grows even thicker.
- ☐ B. It falls out, and brown or gray fur grows in.
- ☐ C. It turns bright red.
- ☐ D. It stays white all year.

Q14 RIT 211 Lexile 580L Inference

The fox has a round body, short legs, and small ears. The passage suggests these body parts help the fox by —

- ☐ A. making it look bigger to enemies.
- ☐ B. helping it hear sounds far away.
- ☐ C. letting it dig deep holes.
- ☐ D. keeping its body heat from escaping into the cold.

Q15 RIT 212 Lexile 600L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Arctic Fox"?

- ☐ A. The most important idea is that the Arctic fox lives in a very cold place.
- ☐ B. The fox's most amazing trick is the way it changes color with the seasons.
- ☐ C. The Arctic fox has special adaptations that help it survive the cold.
- ☐ D. The fox wraps its long, bushy tail around its body like a warm blanket.

Passage 4 · The Monarch's Long Trip

Every fall, millions of monarch butterflies in North America begin an amazing journey. The weather in the north grows too cold for them to live. So the monarchs fly south to warmer forests in Mexico and California, where they can survive the winter. This long trip is called migration. Some monarchs travel as far as three thousand miles. That is a huge distance for an insect that weighs less than a paper clip. How do the butterflies know which way to go? Scientists believe they use the sun like a compass to find their direction. The most surprising part is that no single butterfly makes the whole trip twice. The monarchs that fly south in the fall are not the same ones that flew north the spring before. Somehow, the new butterflies still find their way to the very same forests their great-grandparents used. By migrating, monarchs escape the deadly cold and find a safe place to wait for spring.

160 WORDS · LEXILE 610–680L · RIT 213–215

Q16 RIT 213 Lexile 610L Key Detail

Why do the monarch butterflies fly south every fall?

- ☐ A. The weather in the north grows too cold for them to live.
- ☐ B. They are looking for a paper clip.
- ☐ C. They want to race other insects.
- ☐ D. The forests in the north are too crowded.

Q17 RIT 214 Lexile 630L Vocabulary

In the passage, **migration** is —

- ☐ A. a kind of warm forest.
- ☐ B. a long trip animals make from one place to another.
- ☐ C. a tool used to measure weight.
- ☐ D. the name of a butterfly's wing.

Q18 RIT 214 Lexile 650L Inference

The passage says a monarch weighs "less than a paper clip" to help the reader understand that —

- ☐ A. monarchs are made of metal.
- ☐ B. paper clips can fly.
- ☐ C. it is amazing that such a tiny, light insect travels so far.
- ☐ D. monarchs cannot travel very far.

Q19 RIT 215 Lexile 670L Cause & Effect

According to the passage, how do scientists believe the monarchs find their direction?

- ☐ A. They follow a map drawn by people.
- ☐ B. They listen for other butterflies.
- ☐ C. They smell the warm forests far away.
- ☐ D. They use the sun like a compass.

Q20 RIT 215 Lexile 680L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Monarch's Long Trip"?

- ☐ A. By migrating south, monarch butterflies escape the cold and survive the winter.
- ☐ B. The most surprising idea is that a monarch weighs less than a paper clip.
- ☐ C. Monarch butterflies spend the whole winter in the warm forests of Mexico.
- ☐ D. Scientists believe the butterflies use the sun like a compass to find their way.